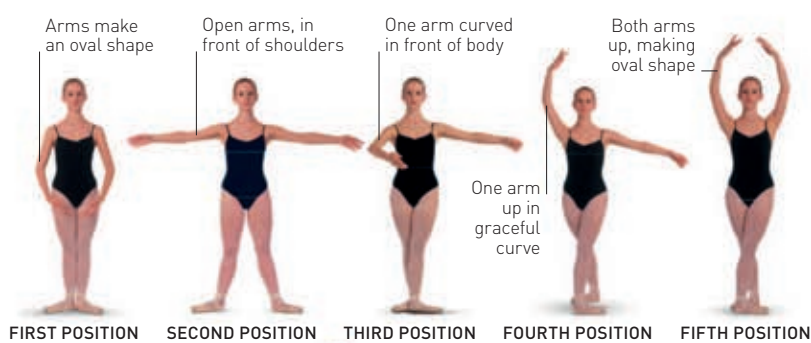


THE BASIC POSITIONS

All the positions and steps in ballet are based on the five basic positions of the feet and arms. For all five foot positions, the feet are flat on the floor and turned out (pointing in opposite directions).



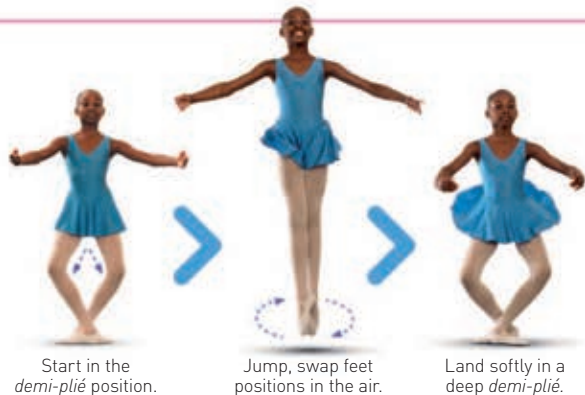
AT THE BARRE

The barre is a handrail in the studio. Dancers hold on lightly to the barre so they can keep their balance while they concentrate on moves and positions.



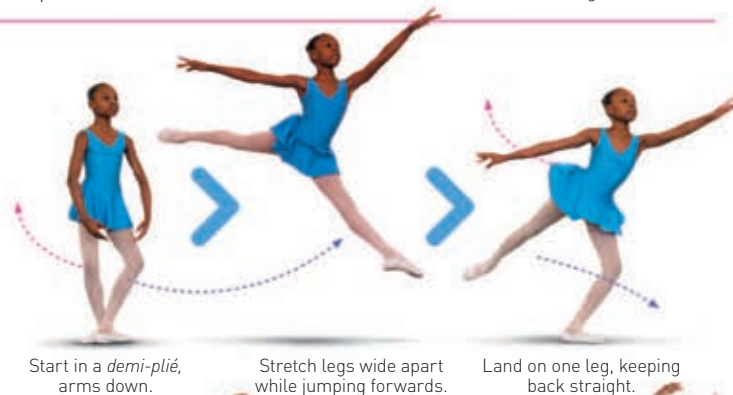
CHANGEMENT

This jump goes straight up and down, with the front foot changing to the back in midair. The movement should be done with an easy bounce – this is called *ballon*. Practise several in a row to build up a stronger jump.



SISSONE OUVERT EN AVANT

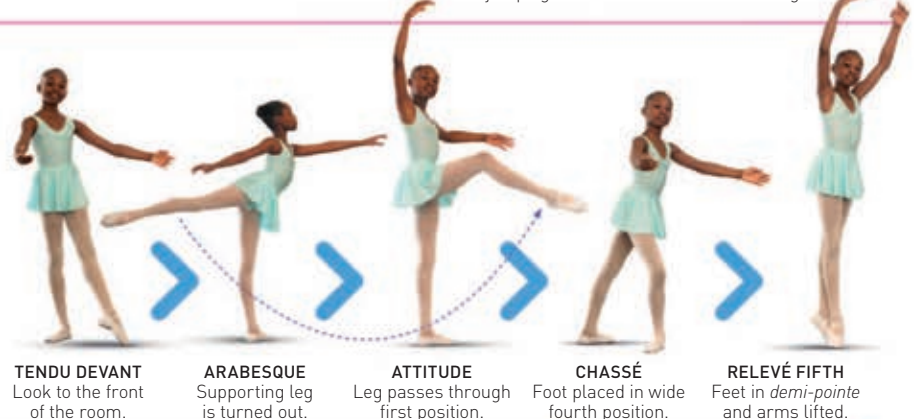
A *sissone* is a jump starting from two feet. There are different kinds, but in this version, the legs open wide in the air, and then the dancer lands on one leg.



A PRINCIPAL BALLERINA CAN GET THROUGH UP TO 12 PAIRS OF POINTE SHOES EVERY MONTH

ADAGE

Adage means “moving smoothly”. Dancers put together a series of positions to make an exercise that improves balance and strengthens muscles.



PAS DE CHAT

This means “cat step” in French. To perform it properly a dancer must spring quickly and land lightly and quietly, just like a cat.



PAS DE DEUX

A *pas de deux* is a dance for two people, usually a man and a woman. It is a musical, physical, and artistic partnership between two dancers that can result in the most breathtaking moments in a performance.



Strong knees and thighs are essential for supporting and lifting

EXPRESSING EMOTION
The *pas de deux* often portrays a romantic vision of love.